# Vasool

An AI collections agent for MSME merchants selling on 30 to 60 day credit

## The problem and the opportunity

**Ravi** runs Ravi Packaging, a small Hyderabad supplier to garages, dealers and fleet operators. Most of his sales are B2B on 30 to 60 day credit, so when an invoice goes overdue he chases it by hand: a WhatsApp, a call, another call. Each payer reacts differently, and one clumsy message can cost him a customer. Late money starves his working capital. He is not alone:

**8.84 crore**
MSMEs registered on Udyam and Udyam Assist (30 Jun 2026). The ceiling of our base: Vasool serves the subset that sells B2B on credit.

**₹8.1 lakh crore**
delayed payments owed to MSMEs, as reported from the Economic Survey (Jan 2026).

**₹3.83 crore**
average receivables unpaid for over 360 days per SME, with 73 days on average to settle an invoice (Recordent 2026, about 1.1 lakh MSMEs).

**Why it is worth solving:** cash that sits in unpaid invoices is working capital the merchant has to borrow or go without, and chasing it takes owner time. The ₹3.83 crore figure comes from a sample skewed to larger SMEs, so a typical micro merchant carries far less; the 8.84 crore base is mostly micro and informal. I treat both as upper bounds, not as a market forecast.

**The opportunity for Razorpay (my arithmetic, not a forecast):** B2B dues are mostly settled today by bank transfer or cheque, outside Razorpay. Every overdue invoice Vasool settles through a Razorpay payment link is new volume, not cannibalised revenue.

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| **Per merchant** | If Vasool moves 10% of a ₹3.83 crore overdue pile (₹38.3 lakh) onto Razorpay links, fees at 1% to 2% are about **₹38,000 to ₹77,000**. |
| **Market** | Each 1% of the ₹8.1 lakh crore stock collected through links is **₹8,100 crore** of new volume, worth about **₹81 to ₹162 crore** in fees at 1% to 2%. |
| **Why 1% to 2%** | Razorpay lists 2% + GST, with no separate Payment Link fee, and says the 2% platform fee also applies to standard UPI despite zero MDR. From 15 Oct 2026 select UPI payments above ₹2,000 carry a 0.4% MDR (capped at ₹300 from ₹75,000), paid by the merchant to its acquiring bank. Large B2B tickets may negotiate custom pricing, so real yield depends on payment mix and agreed pricing, which I have not confirmed. Read 1% to 2% as a planning range, not a conservative case. |

## Evidence and current workaround

The workaround is manual: the owner remembers who is late, picks a channel by gut feel and calls. I modelled it on a synthetic ledger of **10 auto-trade payers, 34 invoices, 15 test replies** (10 English, 5 Hinglish): 8 invoices (about ₹5.3 lakh) overdue, 8 (about ₹8.3 lakh) open, and several of the 11 late-paid invoices paid only after the owner phoned. Payers differ sharply: one pays on day 35, one answers only calls, one habitually disputes, one pays in instalments, one key account must never be auto-contacted. **This ledger is synthetic and not yet validated with real merchants.**

## What I built, for whom, and why it matters

A working prototype (React app in Google AI Studio plus an animated WhatsApp simulation) for the **owner of a small credit-selling business**. Vasool (1) detects overdue invoices, (2) decides channel, timing, tone and offer per payer, (3) drafts the reminder from invoice data only, (4) waits for Ravi's approval, (5) reads the reply (paid, split, reschedule, dispute, resend, opt-out, unclear), (6) drafts the right response, e.g. "₹49,000 now and ₹49,000 on 21 Oct", (7) collects via a Razorpay payment link (real test link, INV-1016, ₹98,000), (8) learns from outcomes, (9) shows a dashboard. It turns a stressful chore into a short daily approval queue and protects the payer relationship.

## Key product and AI decisions

- **Human approves first.** Nothing is sent without Ravi's approval; trust matters more than automation now.
- **Amounts come only from invoice data.** The AI writes the words, never the figures, dates or links.
- **Guardrails are hard rules.** A dispute pauses reminders, opt-outs are honoured, "never auto-contact" accounts are skipped, no pressure tactics.
- **Per-payer personalisation** of channel, language (English, Hinglish, Telugu-English), contact time and tone; **unclear replies go to Ravi**, not to an automated answer.

## What I deliberately left out

Auto-send without approval, payment webhooks, automatic reply capture (replies are pasted in), voice calls, legal notices, credit scoring or lending, any MDR or pricing feature. **Honest gaps:** only INV-1016 has a real link; the "Collected" figures are synthetic.

## Primary success metric and what I would test next

**Metric:** share of overdue rupee value recovered within 14 days of the first reminder; guardrail: approval time per reminder must stay small. **Next:** (1) pilot with 5 to 10 real MSME merchants against their manual chasing; (2) reply-intent accuracy on real Hinglish and Telugu messages, tracking missed disputes as the critical error; (3) approve-all versus review-each; (4) per-payer channel and timing versus a fixed cadence.

**Sources:** 8.84 crore Udyam registrations, KNN India (citing the Minister of State, 30 Jun 2026). ₹8.1 lakh crore: Ascendants (30 Jan 2026) and MSME Sampark, both attributing it to the Economic Survey; I could not open the Survey itself, so treat it as reported. ₹3.83 crore and 73 days: Recordent Indian SME Receivables Report 2026, via MediaBrief and Telangana Today (29 Jun 2026). Fees: razorpay.com/pricing; UPI MDR: Ministry of Finance (PIB) release and DFS FAQ, Sep 2026.